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المملكة المغربية
وزارة التربية الوطنية
والتكوين المهني
والتعليم العالي والبحث العلمي

المركز الجهوي لمهن التربية والتكوين لجهة فاس / مكناس

Teaching the Four Skills

Presented by:

Anas Ben razzouk

Mohammed Taha Ouassif

Hamza Bouhsine

Youssef Hida

Supervised by:

Pr. Laouni Noureddine

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Introduction

Teaching the four language skills is central to effective language education. These skills are **interconnected** and contribute to the development of learners' communicative competence. Successful instruction requires a balance between theoretical understanding, structured classroom practice, and continuous reflection. In this presentation, we will explore how each skill can be taught through this integrated approach.

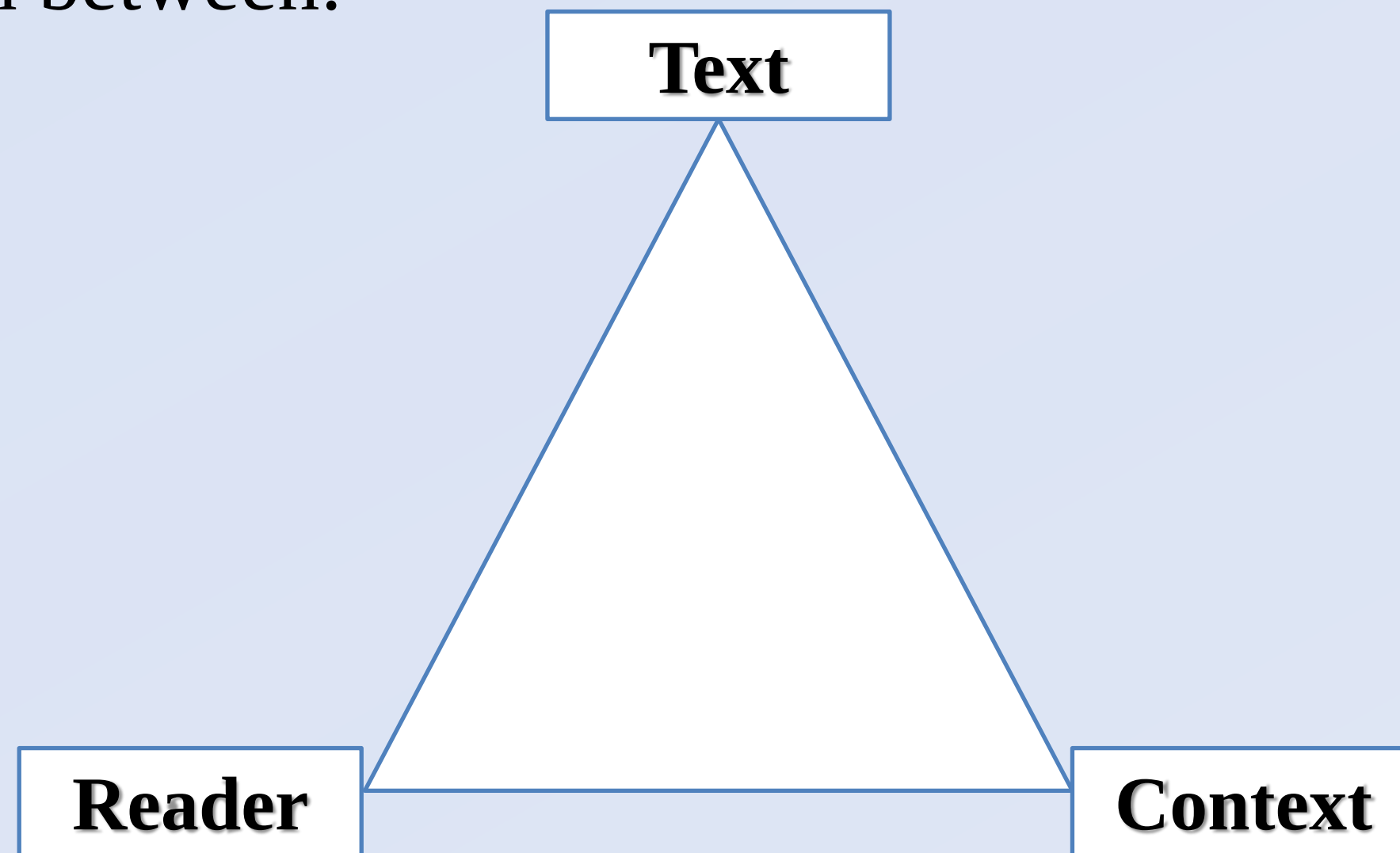
Teaching Reading: Theory, Practice, and Reflection

- **Reading as a core language skill**
- **Foundation for academic success**
- **Develops linguistic and cognitive competence**
- **Requires structured pedagogical approach**

Reading as a Cognitive and Interactive Process

Reading = active construction of meaning

Interaction between:



Theoretical Models of Reading (theory)

1. Bottom-Up Model

- Focus on decoding **letters** → **words** → **sentences**
- Emphasis on linguistic accuracy

2. Top-Down Model

- Focus on prior knowledge (schema)
- Prediction and hypothesis testing

3. Interactive Model

- Combination of bottom-up + top-down
- Most accepted model in modern pedagogy

Reading Sub-Skills and Strategies

- **Skimming** → Identify main idea
- **Scanning** → Locate specific information
- Inferring meaning from context
- Identifying reference words
- Recognizing discourse markers
- Distinguishing fact vs. opinion

Structure of an Effective Reading Lesson (practice)

Three Stages Framework:

1. **Pre-Reading** → Activation
2. **While-Reading** → Guided comprehension
3. **Post-Reading** → Extension and integration

Each stage has a specific pedagogical purpose.

Pre-Reading – Activating Schema

Objectives:

- Activate background knowledge
- Build curiosity
- Set reading purpose

Techniques:

- Brainstorming
- KWL chart
- Title prediction
- Visual prompts
- Key vocabulary

While-Reading – Guided Interaction with the Text

Step 1: **Skimming task**

Step 2: **Scanning task**

Step 3: **Detailed comprehension questions**

Step 4: **Vocabulary in context**

Step 5: **Critical thinking questions**

Teacher's Role:
Facilitator
Strategy trainer
Motivator
Reflective practitioner

Post-Reading – Integration and Skill Transfer

Goals:

- Check global understanding
- Encourage personal response
- Integrate other skills

Activities:

- Group discussion
- Debate
- Writing summary
- Role-play
- Project work

Challenges in Teaching Reading (reflection)

- Limited vocabulary range
- Over-reliance on translation
- Lack of strategic reading
- Mixed-ability classrooms
- Time constraints

Pedagogical Solutions:

- Teach strategies explicitly
- Use differentiated tasks
- Scaffold comprehension
- Encourage extensive reading
- Promote learner autonomy

Listening

1.1 Teaching listening as a skill

Defining listening as a skill:

Listening is a fundamental receptive language skill through which learners receive, interpret, and construct meaning from spoken input. Far from being a passive activity, it is a dynamic and complex cognitive process that involves decoding sounds, identifying vocabulary and grammatical patterns, interpreting intonation, and constructing meaning in real time. In the context of language acquisition, listening provides essential input and lays the groundwork for the development of speaking and overall communicative competence.

Theoretical Models of Listening

1. Bottom-Up Model

- conceptualizes listening as a data-driven process that begins with the recognition of individual sounds and progresses toward overall meaning.
- Comprehension develops sequentially from phonemes to words, phrases, and sentences.
- In this model, accurate decoding of linguistic elements such as vocabulary, grammar, and pronunciation is essential.
- Listening proficiency is therefore closely linked to the listener's linguistic knowledge.

2. Top-Down Model

- recognizes listening as an active meaning-construction process.
- emphasizes the role of background knowledge, expectations, and contextual cues.

3. The Interactive Model

- Integrates both bottom-up and top-down processes
- Proposes that effective listening results from their simultaneous interaction.
- In this framework, listeners continuously shift between analyzing incoming sounds and activating prior knowledge to construct meaning.
- Widely accepted because it captures the adaptive and non-linear nature of listening comprehension.

The Stages of Teaching Listening

1. Pre-Listening Stage

Purpose

prepare learners cognitively, linguistically, and psychologically for the listening task. (Build motivation and engagement)

Objectives

- Activate prior knowledge (schema)
- Establish a clear listening purpose
- Encourage prediction and anticipation
- lowers anxiety

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2. While-Listening Stage

Aims to facilitate meaning-making during listening by providing structured tasks that help learners focus on key information, monitor their understanding, and interpret the message as it unfolds.

Objectives

- Listening for gist
- Extracting specific information
- Identifying details
- Inferring meaning from context

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3. Post-Listening Stage

Helps students reflect on and extend their understanding. It connects listening with other skills such as speaking and writing.

Objectives

- Evaluating ideas
- Check for deeper comprehension
- Summarizing information
- Making inferences

Challenges

- Difficulties Students Encounter
- Difficulty understanding fast speech
- Limited vocabulary and unfamiliar accents
- Anxiety when they don't understand every word
- Trouble concentrating during long recordings

Pedagogical Solutions

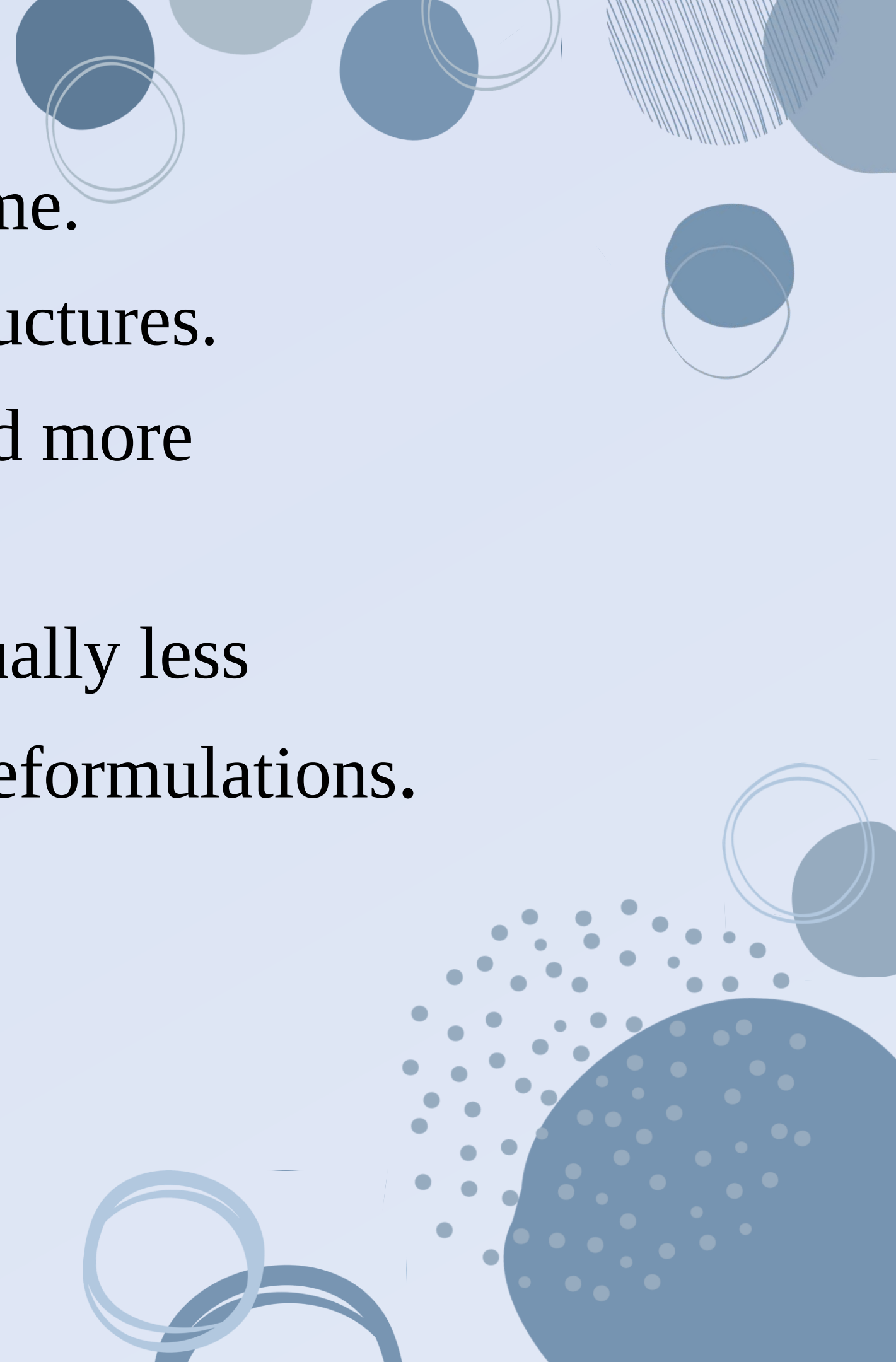
- Divide recordings into shorter segments
- Asking guided questions
- Play recordings more than once with different tasks
- **Pre-teach key vocabulary and expressions** before listening

II. Productive skills: Speaking & Writing

Teaching speaking: theory, practice, and reflection

Defining speaking as skill:

- Speaking is a productive language skill.
- It is a learner-generated form of communication.
- It involves expressing thoughts, ideas, emotions, and information through verbal language.
- During speaking, the speaker makes continuous choices about grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation

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- Unlike writing, speaking occurs in real time.
 - It often involves simpler grammatical structures.
 - Lexical choices tend to be less formal and more spontaneous.
 - Discourse organization in speaking is usually less structured and may include pauses, and reformulations.

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Speaking sub-skills

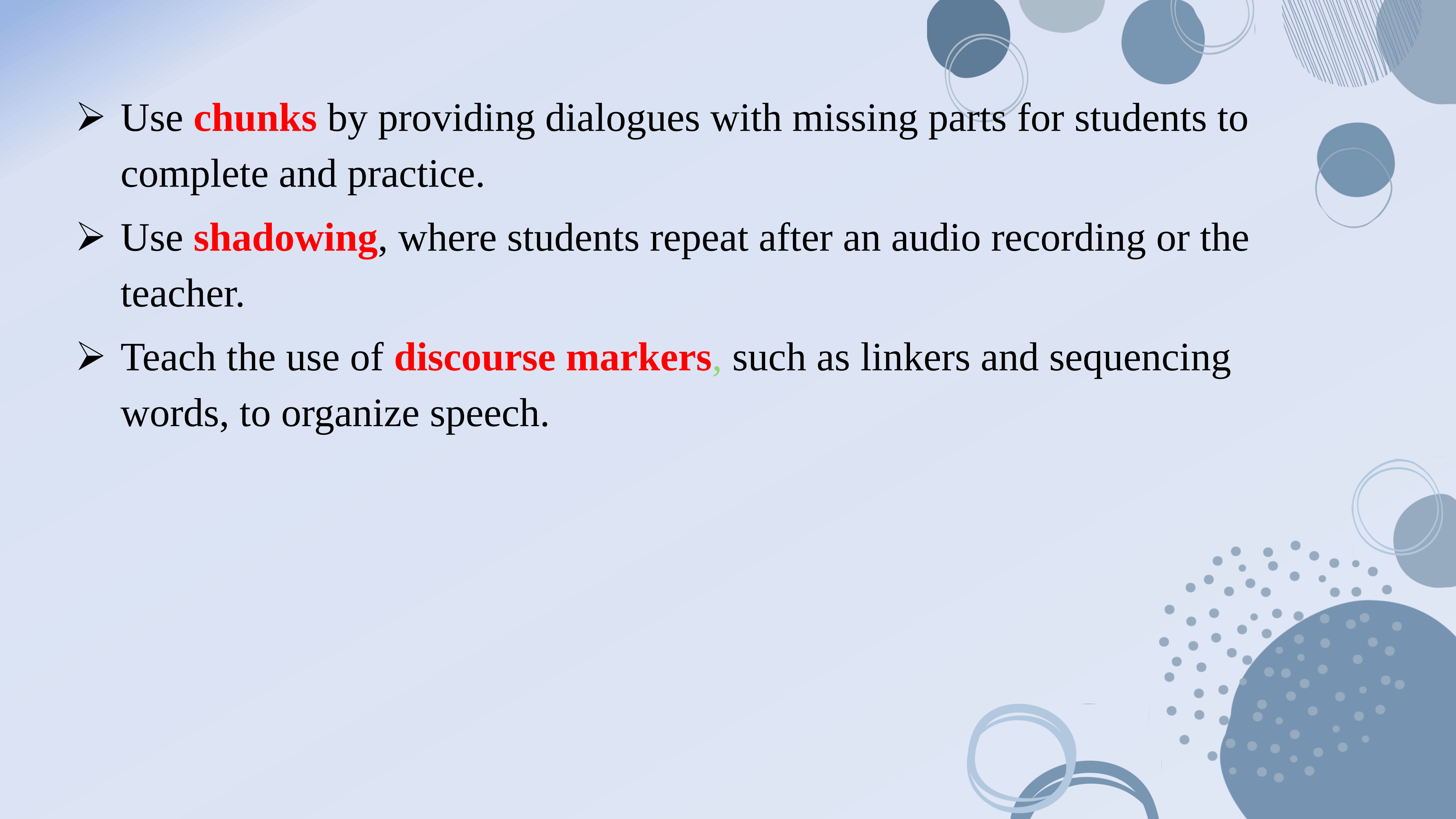
I. Fluency

- The primary purpose of language is communication, particularly spoken communication.
- In second language teaching, this emphasis on meaning rather than form is reflected in the subskill of fluency.
- Fluency refers to the ability to produce speech that flows naturally and smoothly.
- It is characterized by automaticity and effortless processing.
- It involves maintaining a natural pace while speaking.

- Fluency requires the speaker to process language in real time.
- It involves responding quickly without excessive hesitation.
- Fluency prioritizes the communication of meaning over grammatical perfection.
- Minor errors may occur, but they do not prevent understanding.

How to enhance students' fluency

- Use timed speaking tasks.
- Introduce and model pause fillers. e.g., **the thing is / what I mean...**
- Have students describe a personal experience to encourage meaningful communication.

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- Use **chunks** by providing dialogues with missing parts for students to complete and practice.
 - Use **shadowing**, where students repeat after an audio recording or the teacher.
 - Teach the use of **discourse markers**, such as linkers and sequencing words, to organize speech.

II. Accuracy:

Accuracy is often seen as the opposite of fluency, it means producing grammatically correct and well-structured speech where the emphasis is placed on form and correctness rather than spontaneity or the flow of communication.

How to enhance students' accuracy

- Enhance students' accuracy by having them practice role-plays that require using specific grammar forms or vocabulary correctly.
- Use fill-in-the-blank exercises or dialogues to focus on precise language use.
- Provide corrective feedback during or after activities to help students notice and correct errors.
- Encourage repetition and controlled practice to reinforce correct forms.

III. Pronunciation

- ✓ Refers to the way language is spoken.
- ✓ It involves producing clear and understandable speech sounds and patterns.
- ✓ It includes the correct articulation of sounds, word and sentence stress, intonation, and rhythm.

How to enhance students' pronunciation:

- listen and repeat drills
- stress and intonation practice
- the teacher models the pronunciation
- choral repetition

Application

Speaking lesson using PWP framework.

Warm up: Tongue twisters

1. Pre speaking stage

- Brainstorming
- Language preparation
- Model input and listening

2. While speaking stage

- Role plays
- Communicative games (e.g., *Taboo*, *Find Someone Who*, Picture Description)
- Guided Discussions
- Open discussions
- Monologue

3. Post speaking stage

- The teacher provides feedback on students' speaking performance.
- Students reflect on their own performance and the difficulties they encountered.
- The teacher can address and correct common errors observed during the activities.
- Encourage students to set personal goals for improvement based on the feedback.

Reflection

- The teacher reflects on the effectiveness of the speaking activity.
- considers whether the lesson met its learning objectives.
- The teacher evaluates students' engagement, participation, and performance; concerning language features (intonation, stress, and pronunciation).
- Identify patterns in errors or difficulties that students encountered.
- The teacher thinks about adjustments for future lessons, such as modifying tasks, timing, or support strategies.

Introduction to teaching writing

- Writing = productive skill (learners generate language).
- Requires grammar, vocabulary, organization, coherence.
- Supports critical thinking and consolidates other skills.
- Approaches: Process, Product, Genre.

First stage of Teaching writing

Pre-writing stage

- Brainstorming ideas
- Mind-mapping / listing
- Discussing prompts

Drafting stage

- Organizing ideas into sentences/paragraphs - Focus on fluency, not accuracy yet
- Revising stage
- Peer feedback - Teacher guidance - Improving clarity and coherence

Editing stage

- Grammar, spelling, punctuation
- Final polish before submission

Theory

- Writing as a recursive process (plan → draft → revise → edit).
- Process Approach: emphasizes stages of writing.
- Product Approach: focuses on accuracy and final text.
- Genre Approach: models specific text types (letters, essays, reports).
- Writing develops communication + critical thinking.

Practice

- Pre-writing activities: brainstorming, outlining.
- Guided writing: prompts, sentence starters.
- Collaborative writing: pair/group drafting.
- Process writing tasks: multiple drafts + peer review.
- Genre-based tasks: practice real-life texts (emails, essays).
- Example: “My Favorite Hobby” → brainstorm → outline → draft → peer feedback → final version.

Writing Lesson Plan

Teacher: Hicham EL-AZIZI	School: Ibn Batouta H-S
Class/Level: 2nd Bac	Materials: Whiteboard - Textbook
Textbook: Ticket 2 English	Unit 6: Cultural Values
Lesson: Writing A Letter	Time: 55 mins

Objectives: By the end of the lesson, Ss will be able to

- 1- Know the form of letter
- 2- Know how to write descriptive letter
- 2- Use / practice their knowledge in writing

Stage	Activity / Procedure
Warm-up 5 mins	① I greet students. ② Students learn about a new quote
Prewriting 15 mins	① I state the objective of the lesson. ② Brainstorming about the good things in Morocco ③ I show students the format of letter

While-writing
25 mins

- ① Students write the letter in the first draft.
- ② Peer editing: Students exchange papers and correct each other
- ③ Second draft

Post-writing
10 mins

- ① I ask 5 students to stand up and read their writings aloud.
- ② I give positive feedback as a kind of motivation and reinforcement
- ③ Students hand their papers to me.

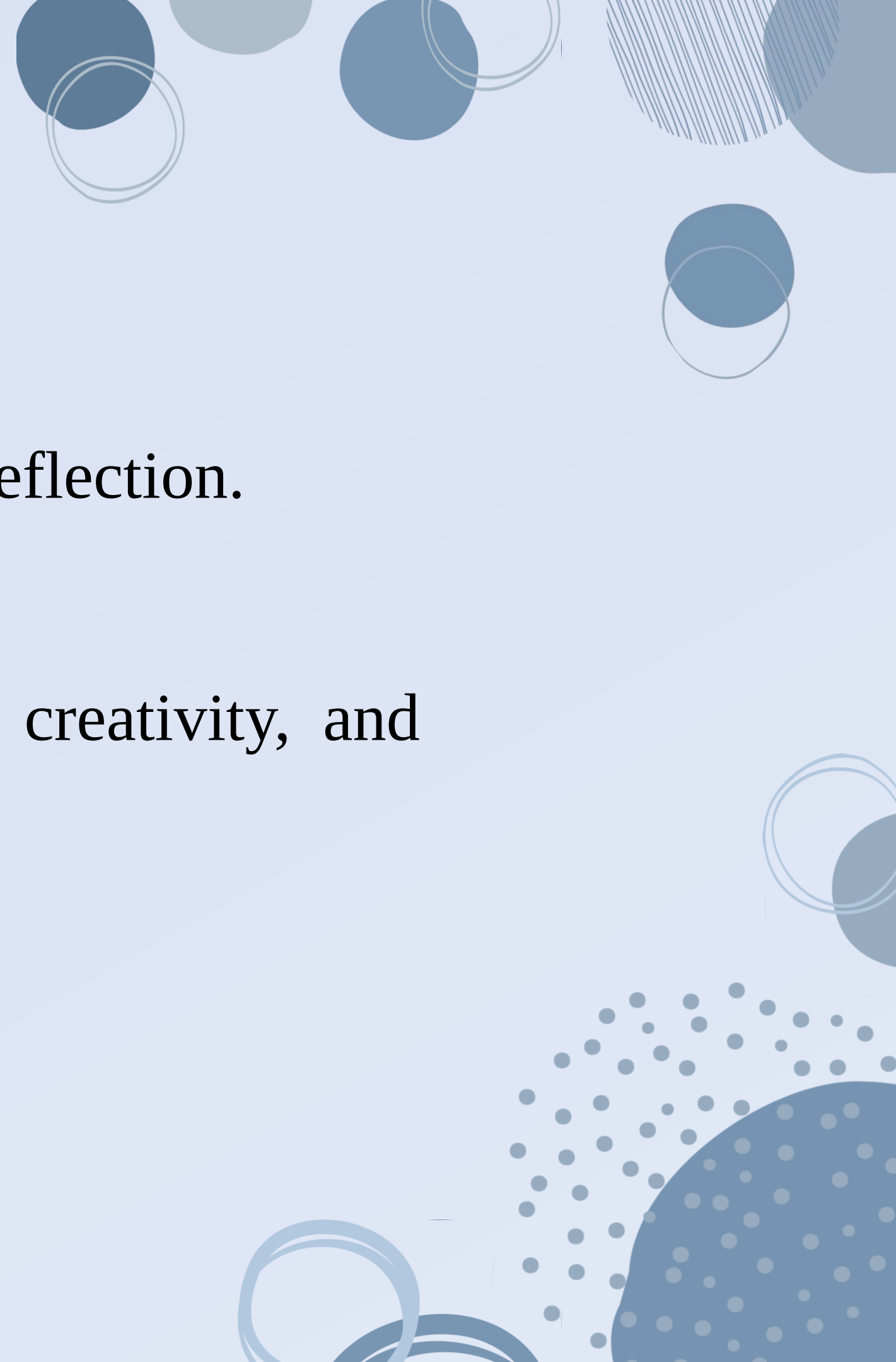
Reflection

Teacher reflection:

- Did students engage in the process or only product?
- Was feedback effective?
- Which approach worked best?

Student reflection:

- Challenges faced (grammar, vocabulary, organization).
- How revising improved their writing.
- Connection to real-life communication (emails, reports).

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- Teaching writing = balance of theory, practice, reflection.
 - Encourage process-oriented learning.
 - Writing is not just accuracy—it's expression, creativity, and communication.

Conclusion

In conclusion, teaching the four skills requires connecting theory with effective classroom practice. Listening and reading build comprehension, while speaking and writing develop expression. Through structured stages and reflective teaching, learners grow in accuracy, fluency, and communicative competence.



Thank you for your attention!